Zverev Reaches the Top of Men's Tennis

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Alexander Zverev will become the men's world number one on Monday. He made sure of it by beating Tallon Griekspoor 6-4 7-5 at the **Erste Bank Open** in Vienna, reaching the **quarter-finals**. He will replace Jannik Sinner at the top. Zverev, 29, is the 30th man to become world number one. He is only the second German to do it, after Boris Becker in 1991. He has already made sure he will finish 2026 as the top player of the year. It has been a great year for him. He has won two **Grand Slam** titles and 64 of his 80 matches. At the start of the year, it seemed that only Sinner or Carlos Alcaraz could be number one. But injuries kept those two out for much of the season, and that opened the door for Zverev. He won the **French Open** and the **US Open**. Zverev said it had been a wait, but sometimes you have to wait for the best things in life. Next, he faces British number one Arthur Fery in the **quarter-finals**.

Word Treasure

Grand Slam -- One of the four biggest and most important tennis tournaments in the world.

quarter-finals -- The round of a tournament where eight players are left, and the winners go on to the semi-finals.

Erste Bank Open -- A tennis tournament held in Vienna where Zverev won the match that secured his top ranking.

French Open -- A major tennis tournament played in France, and one of the Grand Slam events.

US Open -- A major tennis tournament played in the United States, and one of the Grand Slam events.

Background you need

In men's tennis, players earn ranking points from their matches, and the player with the most points is ranked world number one.

The biggest tournaments, called Grand Slams, bring the most attention and ranking points.

A player's season can change quickly when rivals miss matches through injury, opening the way for someone else to climb to the top.

Break it down

WHO: Alexander Zverev, the German tennis player, along with Jannik Sinner, Carlos Alcaraz, Tallon Griekspoor and Arthur Fery

WHAT: Zverev secured the men's world number one ranking by beating Tallon Griekspoor and reaching the quarter-finals

WHERE: At the Erste Bank Open in Vienna

WHY: He won the French Open and the US Open and had a great season while injuries kept Sinner and Alcaraz out for much of the season

Why it matters

It shows that keeping going and waiting for your chance can pay off, even when others seem ahead of you at the start.

Test what you remember

1. Who will Alexander Zverev replace at the top of men's tennis?

- (A) Jannik Sinner
- (B) Boris Becker
- (C) Arthur Fery
- (D) Carlos Alcaraz

2. Whom did Zverev beat to make sure of the top ranking?

- (A) Tallon Griekspoor
- (B) Arthur Fery
- (C) Boris Becker
- (D) Carlos Alcaraz

3. What was the score of that match?

- (A) 6-4 7-5
- (B) 7-5 7-5
- (C) 7-6 6-3
- (D) 6-2 6-2

4. Which two Grand Slam titles did Zverev win this year?

- (A) The French Open and Wimbledon
- (B) The Australian Open and the US Open
- (C) The French Open and the US Open
- (D) Wimbledon and the Australian Open

5. Why did the door open for Zverev this season?

- (A) The rankings system changed
- (B) Injuries kept Sinner and Alcaraz out for much of the season
- (C) His rivals changed coaches
- (D) He moved to Vienna

6. Who does Zverev face next in the quarter-finals?

- (A) Tallon Griekspoor
- (B) Jannik Sinner
- (C) British number one Arthur Fery
- (D) Boris Becker

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: A 4: C 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Alexander Zverev: Says it had been a wait, but sometimes you have to wait for the best things in life.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):